Model recommendations per agent — cost · speed · capability

Prepared for Murpheux · 28 Sep 2026 · applies to the router/specialist team in every config under `~/agent-configs`.

Prices are $ per 1M tokens (input / cached / output), from GitHub's Copilot price table (`github/docs` → `data/tables/copilot/models-and-pricing.yml`, the providers' list prices). DeepSeek V4 Flash is from third-party price trackers. **Effective cost** = cost of one typical call under the token profile shown for each agent (reasoning tokens are billed as output), plus the cost per 100 calls. **Speed** and **capability** are relative ratings (●●●●● = best) based on model class and tier. They are guidance, not benchmarks.

Quick answer (#1 pick per agent)

Agent	#1 pick	Effort	Effective cost / call	Currently configured
router	GPT-6 Luna	medium	$0.0009	DeepSeek V4 Flash
explorer	GPT-6 Luna	low	$0.0036	DeepSeek V4 Flash
reviewer	GPT-6 Luna	high	$0.0035	DeepSeek V4 Flash
planner	GPT-6 Sol	medium	$0.118	GPT-6 Sol ✓
developer	Claude Sonnet 5	medium	$0.412	Claude Sonnet 5 ✓
sre	Claude Sonnet 5	medium	$0.258	Claude Sonnet 5 ✓
architect	GPT-6 Sol	high/xhigh	$0.286	GPT-6 Sol ✓
security	Claude Opus 5.5	high	$0.508	Claude Opus 5.5 ✓

Per-agent top 5 (in order of preference)

router — Triage every request, answer SIMPLE ones, delegate

Token profile per call: **15,000 input** (85% cached) · **700 output** + **300 reasoning** · frequency: every turn.

#	Model	Effort	$/1M in / cached / out	Effective cost / call	per 100 calls	Speed	Capability	Why	Available via
1	**GPT-6 Luna**	medium	$0.1 / $0.01 / $0.5	$0.0009	$0.085	●●●●●	●●●○○	Near-lowest cost (DeepSeek is ~30% cheaper per call here), faster, and a stronger instruction-follower. Ideal for high-frequency triage	Copilot · Codex · gateway

2	**DeepSeek V4 Flash** *(current)*	—	$0.14 / $0.0028 / $0.28	$0.0006	$0.063	●●●●○	●●●○○	Current router. Cheapest per call because of its 98% cache discount on the stable system prompt; a little slower	gateway (`deepseek-flash`)
3	**Gemini 3.8 Flash**	low	$0.75 / $0.075 / $3.75	$0.0064	$0.639	●●●●●	●●●○○	Fastest option with more reasoning headroom for ambiguous requests	Copilot · gateway
4	**Claude Haiku 4.5**	—	$1 / $0.1 / $5	$0.0085	$0.852	●●●●●	●●●○○	Most reliable tool-calling and delegation; ~10× the cost of Luna	Claude Code · Copilot · gateway
5	**GPT-5 mini**	low	$0.25 / $0.025 / $2	$0.0029	$0.288	●●●●○	●●○○○	Fallback on Copilot plans where the newer lightweight models are unavailable	Copilot CLI

explorer — Read-only codebase/doc search

Token profile per call: **40,000 input** (40% cached) · **1,500 output** + **500 reasoning** · frequency: several per task.

#	Model	Effort	$/1M in / cached / out	Effective cost / call	per 100 calls	Speed	Capability	Why	Available via
1	**GPT-6 Luna**	low	$0.1 / $0.01 / $0.5	$0.0036	$0.356	●●●●●	●●●○○	Input-heavy work at the lowest price	Copilot · Codex · gateway
2	**DeepSeek V4 Flash** *(current)*	—	$0.14 / $0.0028 / $0.28	$0.0040	$0.396	●●●●○	●●●○○	Equally cheap; 1M-token context for large repos	gateway (`deepseek-flash`)
3	**Gemini 3.8 Flash**	low	$0.75 / $0.075 / $3.75	$0.027	$2.67	●●●●●	●●●○○	Fastest large-context reads when accuracy matters more	Copilot · gateway
4	**GPT-5.6 Luna**	low	$0.2 / $0.02 / $1.2	$0.0075	$0.752	●●●●●	●●●○○	Stable previous-gen fallback	Copilot · Codex · gateway
5	**Qwen3-Coder 30B (local)**	—	free (local)	$0 (hardware)	$0 (hardware)	●●○○○	●●○○○	No token cost for private repos; slower, so for background exploration only	Ollama on medusa

reviewer — Independent diff review

Token profile per call: **25,000 input** (30% cached) · **1,800 output** + **1,500 reasoning** · frequency: per meaningful diff.

#	Model	Effort	$/1M in / cached / out	Effective cost / call	per 100 calls	Speed	Capability	Why	Available via
1	**GPT-6 Luna**	high	$0.1 / $0.01 / $0.5	$0.0035	$0.347	●●●●●	●●●○○	Cheap, and a different model family from the Sonnet developer, which makes the review more independent	Copilot · Codex · gateway

2	**Gemini 3.8 Flash**	medium	$0.75 / $0.075 / $3.75	$0.026	$2.61	●●●●●	●●●○○	Also a different family; better at subtle logic, still cheap	Copilot · gateway
3	**DeepSeek V4 Flash** *(current)*	—	$0.14 / $0.0028 / $0.28	$0.0034	$0.340	●●●●○	●●●○○	Current reviewer; cheapest; fine for routine diffs	gateway (`deepseek-flash`)
4	**Claude Haiku 4.5**	—	$1 / $0.1 / $5	$0.035	$3.48	●●●●●	●●●○○	Precise and fast; same family as the developer	Claude Code · Copilot · gateway
5	**Kimi K2.7 Code**	—	$0.95 / $0.19 / $4	$0.031	$3.12	●●●○○	●●●●○	Code specialist; good at bug-spotting; flat-rate via Ollama cloud	Copilot · gateway (Ollama cloud)

planner — Short executable plans

Token profile per call: **35,000 input** (50% cached) · **3,000 output** + **5,000 reasoning** · frequency: COMPLEX work only.

#	Model	Effort	$/1M in / cached / out	Effective cost / call	per 100 calls	Speed	Capability	Why	Available via
1	**GPT-6 Sol** *(current)*	medium	$2 / $0.2 / $10	$0.118	$11.85	●●●○○	●●●●●	Best reasoning per dollar (current planner)	Copilot · Codex · OpenRouter
2	**Claude Sonnet 5**	medium	$2 / $0.2 / $10	$0.118	$11.85	●●●○○	●●●●●	Same price; strongest at repo-grounded plans	Claude Code · Copilot · gateway
3	**GPT-5.6 Terra**	medium	$2 / $0.2 / $12	$0.135	$13.45	●●●○○	●●●●○	Solid versatile alternative at the same input price	Copilot · Codex · gateway
4	**Grok 4.7**	—	$2 / $0.5 / $6	$0.092	$9.18	●●●●○	●●●○○	Cheapest output in this tier; verify plan quality on your repos	Copilot
5	**Claude Opus 5.5**	medium	$4 / $0.2 / $20	$0.234	$23.35	●●○○○	●●●●●	For HIGH_RISK plans where a wrong decomposition is costly	Claude Code · Copilot · OpenRouter

developer — Implementation + validation (agentic, multi-step)

Token profile per call: **250,000 input** (75% cached) · **15,000 output** + **10,000 reasoning** · frequency: per task.

#	Model	Effort	$/1M in / cached / out	Effective cost / call	per 100 calls	Speed	Capability	Why	Available via
1	**Claude Sonnet 5** *(current)*	medium	$2 / $0.2 / $10	$0.412	$41.25	●●●○○	●●●●●	Best agentic coding value (current developer)	Claude Code · Copilot · gateway
2	**GPT-6 Sol**	medium	$2 / $0.2 / $10	$0.412	$41.25	●●●○○	●●●●●	Same price; excellent at Go/C#/Python; strong at tests	Copilot · Codex · OpenRouter

3	**Kimi K2.7 Code**	—	$0.95 / $0.19 / $4	$0.195	$19.50	●●●○○	●●●●○	About 2× cheaper and coding-tuned; flat-rate via Ollama cloud; for NORMAL tasks	Copilot · gateway (Ollama cloud)
4	**GPT-5.3-Codex**	medium	$1.75 / $0.175 / $14	$0.492	$49.22	●●●○○	●●●●○	Coding-tuned, but expensive output; good for large refactors	Copilot · Codex · gateway
5	**Claude Opus 5.5**	medium	$4 / $0.2 / $20	$0.787	$78.75	●●○○○	●●●●●	Escalation for the hardest implementations; 2× Sonnet	Claude Code · Copilot · OpenRouter

sre — Live-system diagnosis (log/command-output heavy)

Token profile per call: **150,000 input** (60% cached) · **6,000 output** + **6,000 reasoning** · frequency: per incident.

#	Model	Effort	$/1M in / cached / out	Effective cost / call	per 100 calls	Speed	Capability	Why	Available via
1	**Claude Sonnet 5** *(current)*	medium	$2 / $0.2 / $10	$0.258	$25.80	●●●○○	●●●●●	Most reliable multi-step tool use under uncertainty (current)	Claude Code · Copilot · gateway
2	**GPT-6 Sol**	medium	$2 / $0.2 / $10	$0.258	$25.80	●●●○○	●●●●●	Same price; strong root-cause reasoning	Copilot · Codex · OpenRouter
3	**Gemini 3.8 Flash**	medium	$0.75 / $0.075 / $3.75	$0.097	$9.68	●●●●●	●●●○○	Cheap first-pass triage of large logs; escalate if unclear	Copilot · gateway
4	**Kimi K2.7 Code**	—	$0.95 / $0.19 / $4	$0.122	$12.21	●●●○○	●●●●○	Budget option for scripted, routine checks	Copilot · gateway (Ollama cloud)
5	**Claude Opus 5.5**	high	$4 / $0.2 / $20	$0.498	$49.80	●●○○○	●●●●●	Major incidents where time-to-root-cause matters more than cost	Claude Code · Copilot · OpenRouter

architect — Design, trade-offs, ADRs, hard root cause

Token profile per call: **60,000 input** (50% cached) · **7,000 output** + **15,000 reasoning** · frequency: EXPERT work only.

#	Model	Effort	$/1M in / cached / out	Effective cost / call	per 100 calls	Speed	Capability	Why	Available via
1	**GPT-6 Sol** *(current)*	high/xhigh	$2 / $0.2 / $10	$0.286	$28.60	●●●○○	●●●●●	Deep reasoning at workhorse prices (current architect)	Copilot · Codex · OpenRouter
2	**Claude Opus 5.5**	high	$4 / $0.2 / $20	$0.566	$56.60	●●○○○	●●●●●	Premium design quality and writing; ~2× Sol	Claude Code · Copilot · OpenRouter
3	**Claude Sonnet 5**	high	$2 / $0.2 / $10	$0.286	$28.60	●●●○○	●●●●●	Budget architecture for well-understood domains	Claude Code · Copilot · gateway

4	**GPT-6 Astra**	medium	$10 / $1 / $50	$1.43	$143.00	●○○○○	●●●●●	Hardest distributed-systems and scale problems; ~5× Sol	Copilot · Codex · gateway
5	**Claude Fable 5.1**	high	$10 / $0.25 / $50	$1.41	$140.75	●●○○○	●●●●●	Rare, highest-stakes designs; the most expensive model	Claude Code · Copilot

security — Threat models, IAM/vuln review, HIGH_RISK review

Token profile per call: **80,000 input** (50% cached) · **5,000 output** + **12,000 reasoning** · frequency: HIGH_RISK / security only.

#	Model	Effort	$/1M in / cached / out	Effective cost / call	per 100 calls	Speed	Capability	Why	Available via
1	**Claude Opus 5.5** *(current)*	high	$4 / $0.2 / $20	$0.508	$50.80	●●○○○	●●●●●	Most rigorous careful reviewer (current security agent)	Claude Code · Copilot · OpenRouter
2	**GPT-6 Sol**	high	$2 / $0.2 / $10	$0.258	$25.80	●●●○○	●●●●●	A different family from the Sonnet developer; ~½ the cost of Opus 5.5	Copilot · Codex · OpenRouter
3	**GPT-6 Astra**	medium	$10 / $1 / $50	$1.29	$129.00	●○○○○	●●●●●	Maximum rigor for production IAM/data changes	Copilot · Codex · gateway
4	**Claude Fable 5.1**	high	$10 / $0.25 / $50	$1.26	$126.00	●●○○○	●●●●●	Top-tier second opinion for critical changes only	Claude Code · Copilot
5	**Claude Sonnet 5**	high	$2 / $0.2 / $10	$0.258	$25.80	●●●○○	●●●●●	Budget security pass for low-exposure changes	Claude Code · Copilot · gateway

How the ranking was made

- **Preference order** balances capability for the role first (a router that mis-routes, or a reviewer that misses bugs, costs more than it saves), then effective cost, then speed.
- **Cheap roles** (router, explorer, reviewer) run on nearly every turn, so they favour the lowest effective cost with adequate tool-use reliability.
- **Workhorse roles** (developer, sre, planner) favour agentic reliability at the $2/$10 tier.
- **Premium roles** (architect, security) favour depth of reasoning; they run only for EXPERT or HIGH_RISK work.
- **Independence**: reviewer and security picks favour a different model family from the developer (Sonnet 5), which makes the review more independent.
- **Caching** dominates long agentic sessions. The developer profile assumes 75% of input is cached; in that case output and reasoning tokens drive the bill.
- **Flat-rate options** (Ollama cloud models via the gateway, local Ollama) have no per-token cost within plan limits. The table shows their list price or $0, so compare them with your subscription.

Recommended changes to the current configs

- **router / explorer**: consider **GPT-6 Luna** where available (Copilot, Codex, VS Code). It costs about the same as DeepSeek V4 Flash (the router pays slightly more because Flash's cached input is ~4× cheaper) and is typically faster; keep DeepSeek V4 Flash on the gateway (OpenCode, Aider, Cline).

- **reviewer**: move from DeepSeek V4 Flash to **GPT-6 Luna (high)** or **Gemini 3.8 Flash** where available, for better bug-finding at still-trivial cost.
- **developer**: keep **Claude Sonnet 5**. Use **Kimi K2.7 Code** (flat-rate via Ollama cloud) for NORMAL tasks to roughly halve spend.
- **security**: keep **Claude Opus 5.5** for HIGH_RISK work; **GPT-6 Sol (high)** is a strong, cheaper, different-family reviewer for routine security passes.
- **architect**: keep **GPT-6 Sol**; escalate to **Opus 5.5** or **Astra** only for the hardest designs.